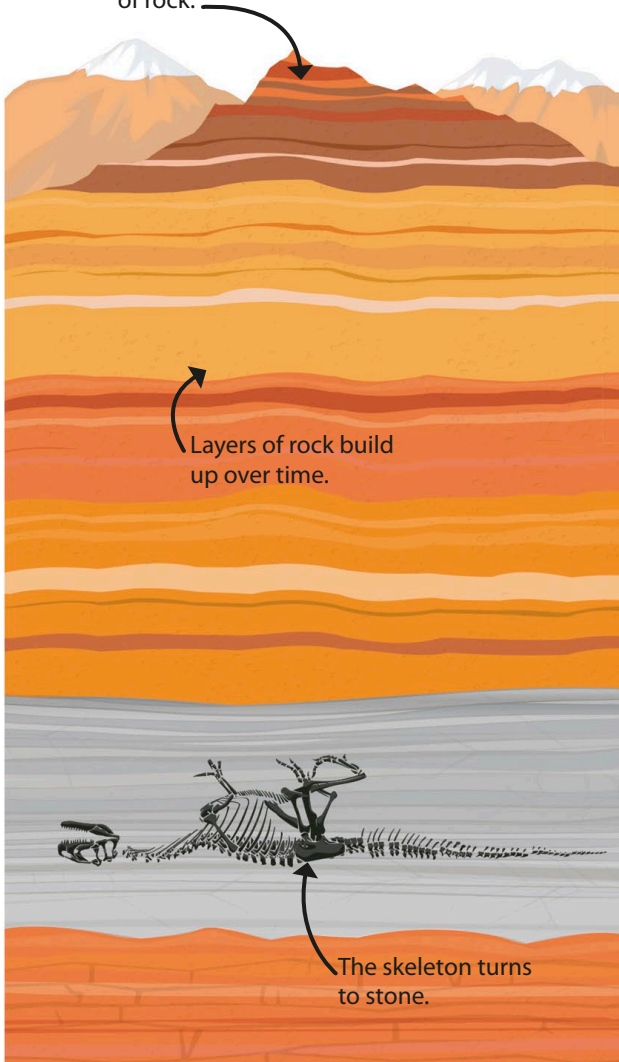


Mountains may form on top of the older layers of rock.



Layers of rock build up over time.

The skeleton turns to stone.

2 MILLION YEARS AGO

Mineralization

Minerals in the ground enter the bones and over time are turned into rock. The Allosaurus is turned to stone, like the surrounding layers of sediment. The top layers of rock begin to erode (wear down) as rain, wind, and frost break them up and wash them away.

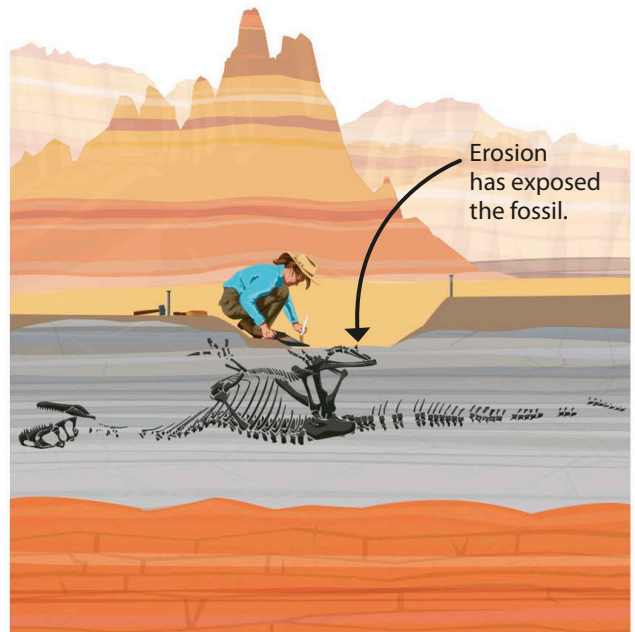
Trace fossils

Body fossils, like skeletons, are a direct look at dinosaurs themselves, but other remains also provide information. Trace fossils are preserved signs of life, such as footprints and dung. These build a picture of how dinosaurs walked, lived, and fed.



Coprolites

Coprolites are fossilized dung. Some still contain the remains of the dinosaur's last meal!



Erosion has exposed the fossil.

5 YEARS AGO

Discovery

A paleontologist spots a bone sticking out of the ground and discovers the dinosaur. An Allosaurus from the Jurassic period! Erosion has continued to wear down and carry away the rock around the Allosaurus until part of it is visible. The rest of the skeleton can then be carefully dug up.